



THE CONTINENT OF SOUTH AMERICA COMPRISES 12 countries, plus the dependency of French Guiana. Offshore territories include the Galapagos Islands (Ecuador),

SOUTH AMERICA

HOME OF THE DISAPPEARING RAIN FOREST

Global position

Joined to Central America by the Isthmus of Panama, South America lies across the equator. Because it is rapidly being destroyed, the vast tropical rain forest around the Amazon River is one of the world's most environmentally sensitive sites.



Spoken difference
English is the national language of Guyana.

Longest river
Amazon, Brazil
4,050 miles (6,516 km)

Largest lake
Lake Titicaca,
Bolivia/Peru
3,220 sq miles
(8,340 sq km)

Largest city
São Paulo, Brazil
18 million people

Isolated colony
There are about 27,000
Protestant Mennonites
in Paraguay.

Caracas
cityscape,
Venezuela

Falkland
Islands
(to UK)

Cape Horn